

in both these laptops, similar to others. The surface of both laptops is non-glossy, so they both hide fingerprints decently well. But it is the HP Omen 16 which has a proper matte finish as opposed to a “powder-like” coating on the Acer Nitro 5. The HP Omen 16’s trackpad manages to contain the fingerprints well and keep the surface smudge-free compared to the one on the Acer Nitro 5, which catches fingerprints fairly easily.

Moving on to the hinge quality, it is a tie. Since both laptops pack some powerful components, nearly identical to be specific, they are lined up with air vents. You can find air vents on the side and on the back of the laptop. Both laptops feature a vent placed adjacent to the keyboard but it works differently in each of them. On the HP Omen 16, the vent works as an additional air vent to cool the laptop. But it houses an additional speaker on the Acer Nitro 5 instead.

Now, overall, if I had to say which laptop feels more solid in terms of overall build quality I wouldn’t choose at all. Because both, the HP Omen 16 and the Acer Nitro 5 are built really well.

Display comparison

Both laptops come with a display that supports 165Hz but the similarities mostly end there. The Acer Nitro 5 has a 16:10 aspect ratio screen with 1920 x 1200 maximum resolution support and Nvidia G-Sync support. It also has a really impressive 505 nits of peak brightness, which is one of the highest in its class. Even in a lit-up office room, the screen overpowers the surrounding light for an immersive viewing experience.

Moreover, the laptop also has 98% sRGB and 73.4% DCI-P3 colour space coverage. Meaning, that most of the content that you watch on YouTube will have a wide gamut of colours. Additionally, the laptop’s display is not just super bright but also highly accurate with a Delta E value of just 1.9 in the sRGB colour space, making it suitable for content creation as well.

On the other hand, the HP Omen 16 comes with a traditional 16:9 aspect ratio screen which supports 1920 X 1080 maximum resolution. Just like the Nitro

5’s display, the one of the HP Omen 16 also features an anti-glare coating. In terms of brightness, the HP Omen 16’s display has a peak luminance of 303 nits, which is less than its competitor. Furthermore, it has 98% sRGB and 75% DCI-P3 colour space coverage. Likewise, in terms of colour accuracy, the HP Omen 16 also fares really well with an even better Delta E score of 1.5, probably the highest in its class.

Gaming performance

It is always really fascinating to see how two laptops perform, especially if they have identical specifications. So to thoroughly test both these laptops in our comparison, I ran gaming benchmarks multiple times.

In the synthetic benchmark tests, both laptops showcased competitive performance, but there were some noticeable differences. Starting with the Cinebench R20 results, the HP Omen 16 slightly trailed in the 1-Thread test with a score of 682 compared to the Acer Nitro 5’s 690. However, it took the lead in the n-Thread test, scoring 6897 against the Nitro 5’s 6488.

The Cinebench R23 results were neck and neck in the 1-Thread test with scores of 1764 and 1765, respectively. Yet, the Omen 16 again outperformed in the n-Thread test, registering a score of 17681 compared to the Nitro 5’s 17051.

In the WinRAR benchmark, the Omen 16 achieved a higher resulting KB/s of 21253, surpassing the Nitro 5’s 19898. The 7-Zip benchmark revealed mixed results: while the Omen 16 dominated in the compressing GIPS with a score of 74.263 against the Nitro 5’s 63.691, it fell behind in the decompressing GIPS, scoring 89.314 compared to the Nitro 5’s impressive 113.771.

I also ran all these tests without any downtime, to ensure that I pushed these gaming laptop’s cooling performance to the limit. The NVIDIA GeForce RTX 4060 GPU powering both laptops has 140W TGP and 8GB GDDR6 VRAM. Furthermore, the Acer Nitro 5 comes with NVIDIA Advanced Optimus which automatically switches between the iGPU and the discrete graphics chip.

Meanwhile, on the HP Omen 16, you only get a MUX switch which requires you to manually change between the iGPU

and the dGPU and requires a restart every time. But the result in both cases is same.

During the gaming benchmarks, I kept both laptops in performance mode. I kept the fans in auto mode because the FPS gain was merely of 1 or 2 FPS at most. And lastly, I kept all these benchmarks at high graphics preset at 1080p resolution.

The NVIDIA GeForce RTX 4060 works amazingly well in both laptops delivering 100+ FPS in many titles. However, there can only be one winner and it is the HP Omen 16. While it just bests Acer Nitro 5 in games like Dirt 5 and Metro Exodus, it outright beats the HP Omen 16 by a noticeable margin in games like Gears 5, Shadow of the Tomb Raider, and AC Valhalla. The Acer Nitro 5 beats the HP Omen 16 in Ray Tracing performance. Both in the Metro Exodus RTX test and in 3D Mark’s Port Royale test, the Acer Nitro 5 beats the HP Omen 16. The difference isn’t too much.

In the Crystal Disk Mark SSD speed test results, the Acer Nitro 5 again trumps the HP Omen 16 by a small margin. One major issue that I also have to highlight with the Acer Nitro 5 is the vibrations. Acer boasts ultra-fast cooling fans in the Nitro 5 gaming laptop. But these fans are so loud and produce so much vibration that playing games for an extended period on the Acer Nitro 5 becomes a tiresome affair.

That is not the case on the HP Omen 16 where the fans are still pretty loud but they don’t produce pestering vibrations. As a further note, I’d like to remind you that the laptops I tested were not review units but instead units purchased from Amazon. So it’d be that my specific model has the vibration issue and I’d reach out to Acer for any clarification and update this article accordingly. However, for the time being, the issue remains so I have to report it.

Verdict

Whether you value display quality, storage space, or cooling efficiency, both laptops have their strengths and weaknesses. But if you’re looking purely from a gaming performance perspective, the HP Omen 16 easily comes out on top and when you consider that it costs ₹4,000 less at ₹1.25 lakh compared to the Acer Nitro 5 which will set you back ₹1.29 lakh. **[d]**